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Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

20 single-page puzzles
Every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This pack belongs to

_____

[Publisher line: wording to be confirmed by the owner]

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- Print this PDF and photocopy any page for the pupils and staff of the school named above.
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Notes

The licence is for the edition bought. The school name shown on each page is set when the pack is made.

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Teacher notes (DRAFT)

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What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (10 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (10 pages). Pages can be used in any order.

Every page checks itself

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip does not say what the word is; there is no clue to guess it from.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes.
- **Logic grid.** Each number or price has a letter; the letters, read down the list, must spell a word.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the stated total (P1-20 adds a second sum for the two questions).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

For every page, a script tried each single wrong answer (one answer changed by 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 or 10, or any other value in the page's range) and every wrong arrangement of the logic pages. The check rejected at least 95% of them on every page. A wrong answer that happens to spell any English word from a list of about 129 000 words counts as not rejected.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (P1-01, P1-12, P1-14) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). The outline is printed black and white; the colour words in the key are what the pupil follows.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **When to use.** Some topics are usually taught later in the year: P1-03, P1-05, P1-06, P1-12, P1-13, P1-15, P1-16, P1-17, P1-18, P1-19, P1-20. P1-06 uses o'clock and half past; P1-18 reads times to 5 minutes and is usually used late in the year. Check your scheme of work before giving out these pages.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only; the back of a copy stays blank. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on P1-17 a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

What is in this pack

Part	Pages	Photocopy for pupils?
Cover	1	No
Photocopy licence	1	No
Teacher notes	2	No
Contents	1	No
Puzzle pages P1-01 to P1-20	20	Yes
Complete pack to print	**25**	The teacher answer key is a separate file.

Contents

Page	Puzzle	Topic	Tier
P1-01	Colour the Rocket	Place value: tens and ones	1 star
P1-02	Mystery Numbers	Numbers to 100: tens digit, ones digit, more and less	2 stars
P1-03	Fair Shares	Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)	1 star
P1-04	Sticker Grid	Comparing numbers to 100 (more, fewer, greatest, smallest)	2 stars
P1-05	Times Code	Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number	2 stars
P1-06	What Time Is It?	Time: o'clock and half past	1 star
P1-07	The Queue	Ordinal numbers: 1st to 5th, in front of and behind	2 stars
P1-08	Make Twelve	Addition within 20	1 star
P1-09	Magic Square	Adding three 1-digit numbers	2 stars
P1-10	Take Away Code	Subtraction within 20; missing numbers	1 star
P1-11	Big Number Sums	Add and subtract within 100	2 stars
P1-12	Colour the House	Shapes: corners	1 star
P1-13	Equal Groups	Multiplication: equal groups	1 star
P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s	2 stars
P1-15	Coin Purses	Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)	1 star
P1-16	Shop Prices	Money: dollars, more and less	2 stars
P1-17	How Long?	Length: measure in centimetres	1 star
P1-18	Clock Time	Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later	2 stars
P1-19	Shape Count	2D shapes: rectangle, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle	1 star
P1-20	Fruit Graph	Picture graphs: read, complete and answer	2 stars

Pages are independent. Pick any page.

P1-01

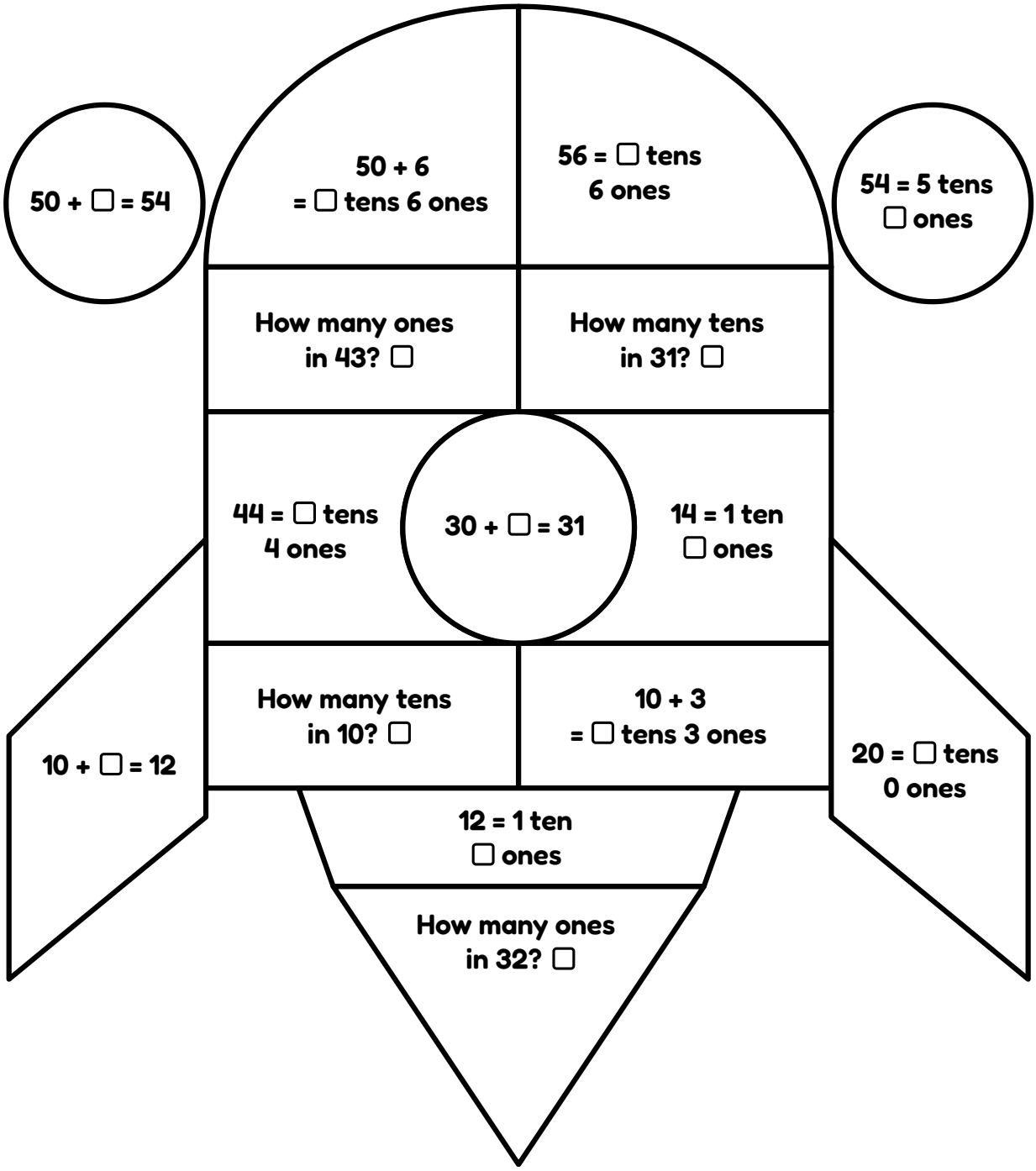
Colour the Rocket

Name _____

Topic: Place value: tens and ones

Find the missing number in each part.
Find it in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

1	2	3	4	5
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 3, red 4, blue 2, green 4, orange 2.
Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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P1-02

Mystery Numbers

★★ Name _____

Topic: Numbers to 100: tens digit, ones digit, more and less

Find each mystery number.
Write it in the box.
Use the code table.

1. My ones digit is 6.
   I am less than 73.
   I am more than 59. ☐

2. My ones digit is 5.
   I am less than 95.
   I am more than 82. ☐

3. My tens digit is more than 2.
   I am less than 38.
   My ones digit is 6. ☐

4. I am less than 61.
   My ones digit is 6.
   My tens digit is more than 4. ☐

5. I am more than 23.
   My ones digit is 6.
   I am less than 34. ☐

Code table

24 = J	26 = D	34 = W	36 = O	37 = X	54 = Z
55 = K	56 = U	66 = C	85 = L		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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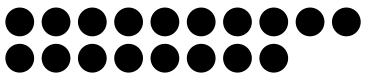
P1-03

Fair Shares

★ Name _____

Topic: Sharing equally and making equal groups (within 20)

Look at the dots.
Write how many.
Use the code table.

1		Share 18 dots equally among 3 plates. How many on each plate?	
2		Put 15 dots in groups of 5. How many groups?	
3		Share 16 dots equally among 2 plates. How many on each plate?	
4		Put 15 dots in groups of 3. How many groups?	
5		Share 8 dots equally among 2 plates. How many on each plate?	
6		Put 10 dots in groups of 5. How many groups?	

Code table

1 = Q	2 = D	3 = R	4 = N	5 = E	6 = F
7 = J	8 = I	9 = K	10 = Z	11 = W	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word?

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P1-04

Sticker Grid

★★ Name _____

Topic: Comparing numbers to 100 (more, fewer, greatest, smallest)

Read the clues.
Use the grid to cross and tick.
Write each number, then its letter.

The numbers of stickers are:

12 O	23 L	63 B	78 E	99 W

- Ali has fewer than Mei.
- Kumar has more than Mei.
- Ben has fewer than Siti.
- Ali has more than Siti.

How to use the grid

	5	9
Zed	✓	×
Yan	×	

Clue: Zed has 5.
Tick Zed under 5.
Cross out the rest of that line across and down.

	12	23	63	78	99
Ali					
Mei					
Siti					
Ben					
Kumar					

	number	letter
Ali		
Mei		
Siti		
Ben		
Kumar		

Check it. Read the five letters down your list. Do they spell a word?

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P1-05

Times Code

★★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication within 40: groups of, and the missing number

3 × 4 means 3 groups of 4.
Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 4 × 5 = ☐

② 4 × ☐ = 16

③ ☐ × 5 = 25

④ 10 × 3 = ☐

⑤ 3 groups of 2 = ☐

⑥ 2 groups of 5 = ☐

Code table

2 = N	4 = Q	5 = U	6 = R	7 = P	10 = E
15 = D	19 = J	20 = S	30 = A	40 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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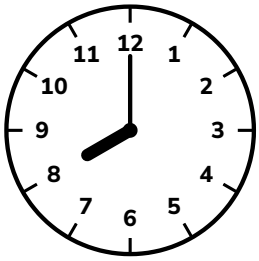
P1-06

What Time Is It?

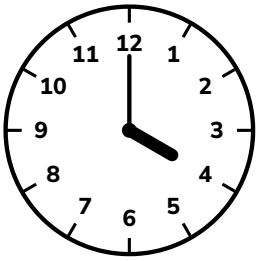
Name _____

Topic: Time: o'clock and half past

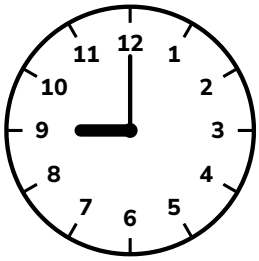
Read each clock.
Write the time in the boxes.
Use the code table.

1 

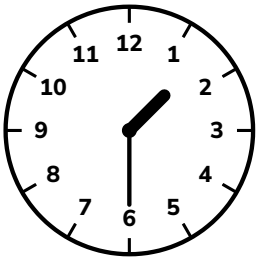
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

2 

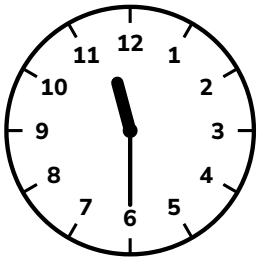
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

3 

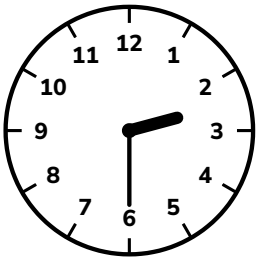
What is the time? ☐ : ☐

4 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

5 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

6 

What is the time? ☐ : ☐

Code table

11:30 = N	9:00 = C	4:00 = E	1:00 = X	8:00 = S
3:00 = Q	4:30 = R	1:30 = O	2:30 = D	5:00 = B

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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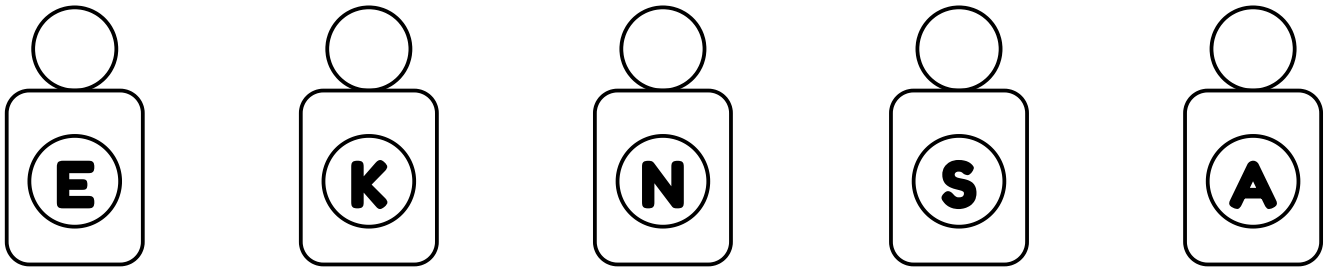
P1-07

The Queue

★★ Name _____

Topic: Ordinal numbers: 1st to 5th, in front of and behind

The children stand in a queue.
Read the clues.
Write each name in its place.



Lily Ravi Aisha Jenny Ali

The queue. The front is 1st.

1st ☐

2nd ☐

3rd ☐

4th ☐

5th ☐

- Ravi is 4th in the queue.
- Aisha is next to Ali.
- Aisha is next to Jenny.
- Ali is behind Aisha.

Check it. Read the shirt letters from 1st to 5th. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-08

Make Twelve

★ Name _____

Topic: Addition within 20

Start at START.
Step only on sums that make 12.
Move up, down, left or right.

6 + 6	6 + 6	5 + 7	6 + 4
9 + 3	2 + 6	9 + 3	FINISH 4 + 8
5 + 7	6 + 2	8 + 4	9 + 5
START 8 + 4	3 + 9	9 + 5	4 + 7

Check it. Does your line reach FINISH? Count its boxes: are there 8? Does every box make 12?

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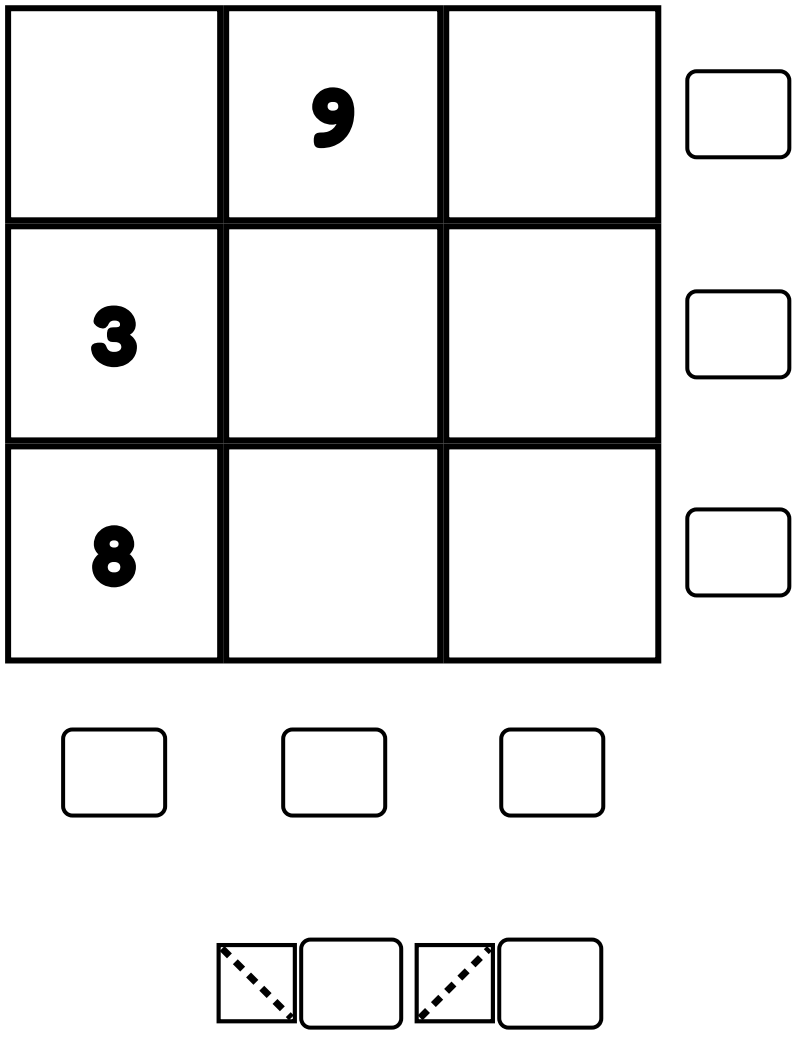
P1-09

Magic Square

★★ Name _____

Topic: Adding three 1-digit numbers

Use the numbers 1 to 9 once.
Every line across and down makes 15.
Both lines from corner to corner make 15.



Numbers to use. Cross out each one you use.

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9

Check it. Write each line total in the small boxes. Are all eight totals 15?

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P1-10

Take Away Code

★ Name _____

Topic: Subtraction within 20; missing numbers

Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 18 – 9 = ☐

② 15 – 8 = ☐

③ 8 – 4 = ☐

④ 10 – 2 = ☐

⑤ 17 – ☐ = 12

⑥ 19 – ☐ = 3

Code table

2 = U	4 = R	5 = A	7 = T	8 = E	9 = S
10 = B	15 = Z	16 = M	17 = X	19 = J	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-11

Big Number Sums

★★ Name _____

Topic: Add and subtract within 100

Find the missing numbers.
Use the code table.

① 31 – 10 = ☐

② 84 – 3 = ☐

③ 54 + 40 = ☐

④ 67 – ☐ = 33

⑤ ☐ + 20 = 47

⑥ 21 + 2 = ☐

Code table

11 = N	17 = P	21 = F	23 = Y	27 = L	31 = W
34 = I	37 = J	71 = Z	81 = A	94 = M	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-12

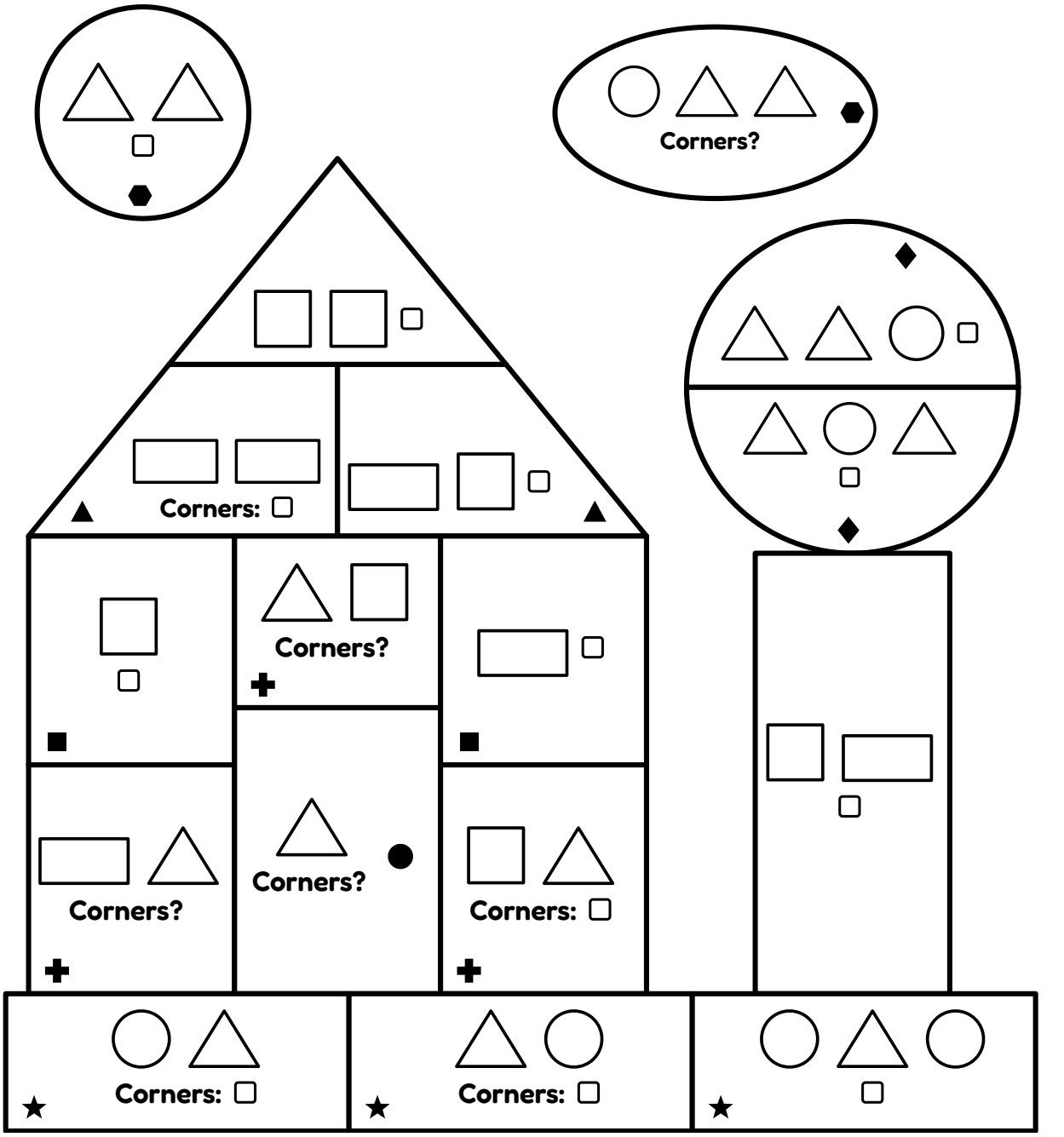
Colour the House

Name _____

Topic: Shapes: corners

Count the corners in each part.
Find the number in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

3	4	6	7	8
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 4, red 2, blue 4, green 3, orange 4.

Parts with the same small mark have the same colour: ▲ ■ ◆ ★ ✚ ⬢

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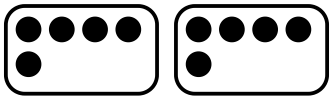
P1-13

Equal Groups

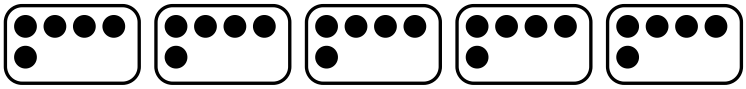
★ Name _____

Topic: Multiplication: equal groups

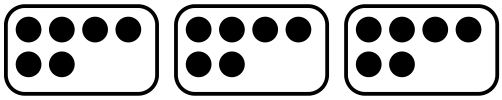
Each bag has the same number of dots.
Write the bags, the dots and the total.
Use the code table.

1 

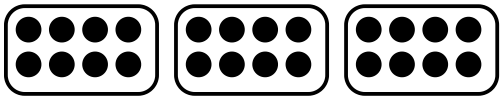
bags × dots = total

2 

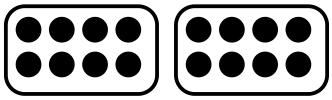
bags × dots = total

3 

bags × dots = total

4 

bags × dots = total

5 

bags × dots = total

6 

bags × dots = total

Code table

10 = N	11 = P	12 = G	16 = E	18 = M	19 = Q
20 = R	24 = B	25 = U	26 = J	35 = Z	

Check it. Write the letters in order.
Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐☐

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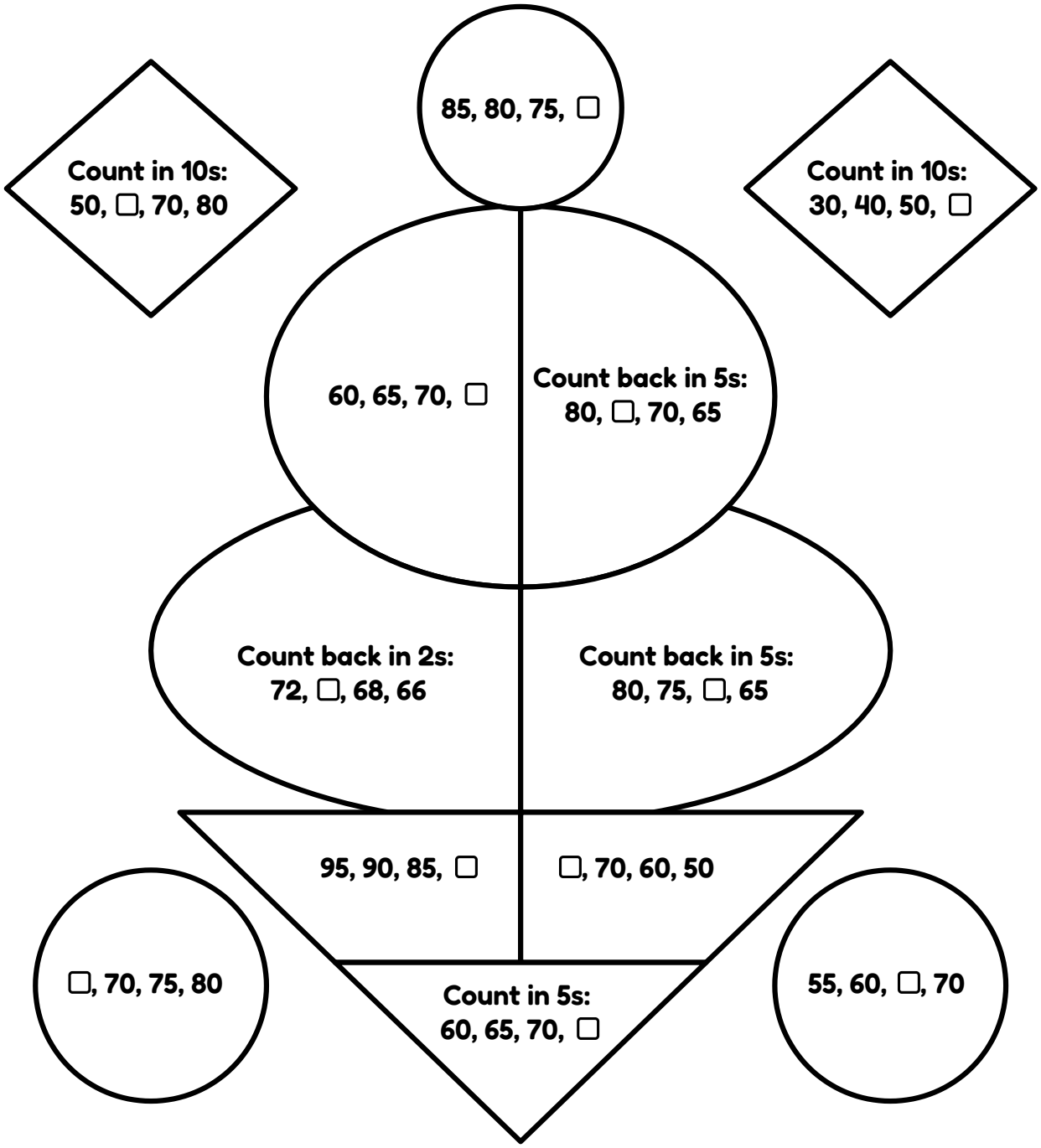
P1-14 Colour the Ice Cream

★★ Name _____

Topic: Counting in 2s, 5s and 10s

Find the missing number in each pattern.
Find it in the key.
Colour the part with that colour.

60	65	70	75	80
yellow	red	blue	green	orange



Check it.
Count the parts of each colour. You should have: yellow 2, red 2, blue 3, green 3, orange 2.
Parts in the same place on the left and on the right have the same colour.

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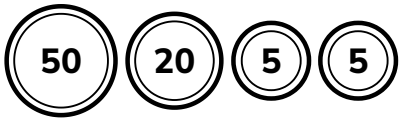
P1-15

Coin Purses

Name _____

Topic: Money: counting coins in cents (up to $1)

Add the coins in each purse.
Write the total in cents.
Use the code table.

1. 

_____ ¢

2. 

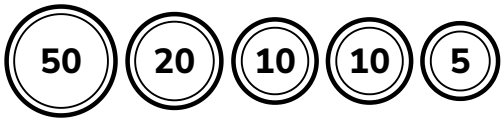
_____ ¢

3. 

_____ ¢

4. 

_____ ¢

5. 

_____ ¢

Code table

15 = Z	25 = N	40 = A	45 = Q	60 = I	75 = C
80 = P	85 = X	95 = O	100 = W		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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P1-16

Shop Prices

★★ Name _____

Topic: Money: dollars, more and less

Read the clues.
Use the grid to cross and tick.
Write each price, then its letter.

The prices are:

$5 N	$7 A	$8 D	$12 M	$15 O

- The kite costs $3 more than the ball.
- The book costs more than the pen.
- The pen costs more than the cup.
- The pen costs more than the ball.

How to use the grid

	5	9
Zed	✓	✗
Yan	✗	

Clue: Zed has 5.
Tick Zed under 5.
Cross out the rest of that line across and down.

	$5	$7	$8	$12	$15
pen					
book					
ball					
kite					
cup					

	price	letter
pen		
book		
ball		
kite		
cup		

The ball and the pen cost $ ____ together. Code letter ____

Code table

$7 = X	$15 = Z	$17 = Y	$18 = Q

Check it. Read your six letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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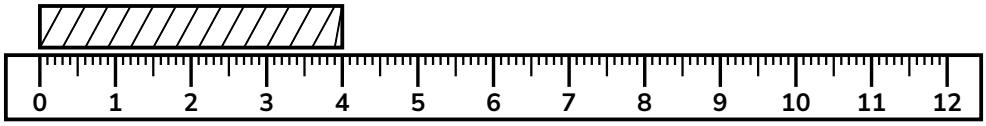
P1-17

How Long?

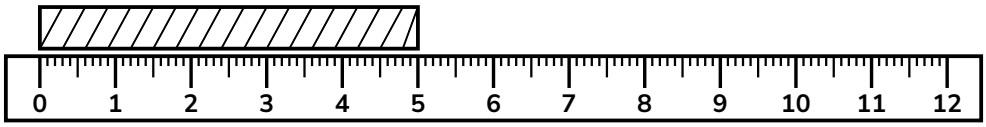
Name _____

Topic: Length: measure in centimetres

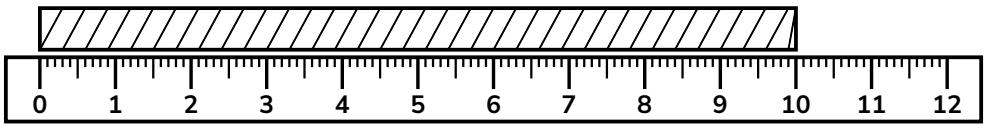
Each strip starts at 0 on its ruler.
Write how long it is in cm.
Use the code table.

1 

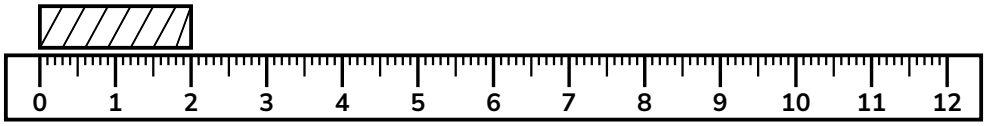
cm

2 

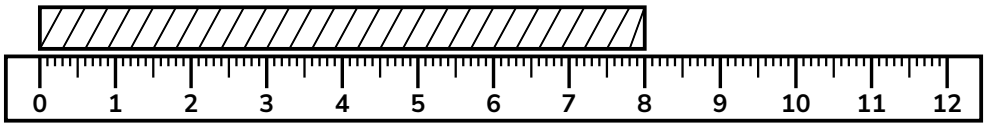
cm

3 

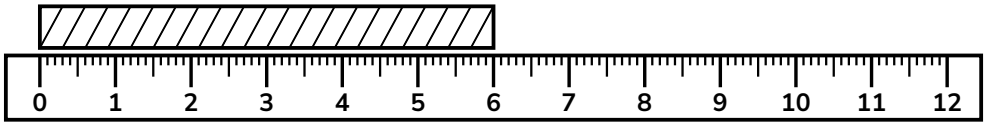
cm

4 

cm

5 

cm

6 

cm

Code table

1 = W	2 = G	3 = M	4 = L	5 = E	6 = H
7 = X	8 = T	10 = N	11 = U		

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word?

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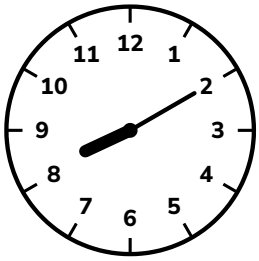
P1-18

Clock Time

★★ Name _____

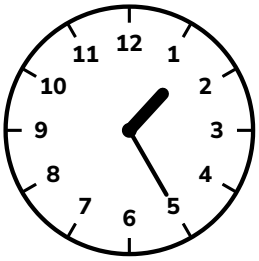
Topic: Time to 5 minutes: 1 hour and half an hour later

Read each clock.
Find the time later.
Write it in the boxes.

1 

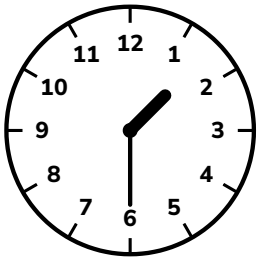
What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

2 

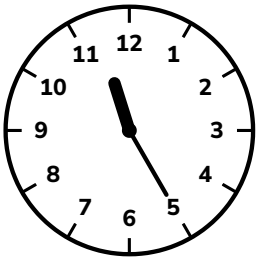
What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

3 

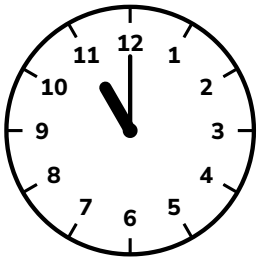
What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

4 

What is the time **half an hour later**?

☐ : ☐

5 

What is the time **1 hour later**?

☐ : ☐

Code table

12:55 = Y	8:10 = X	2:30 = E	9:10 = O	11:55 = A
1:55 = C	11:00 = Z	5:05 = V	12:00 = N	

Check it. Write the letters in order. Do they spell a word? ☐☐☐☐☐

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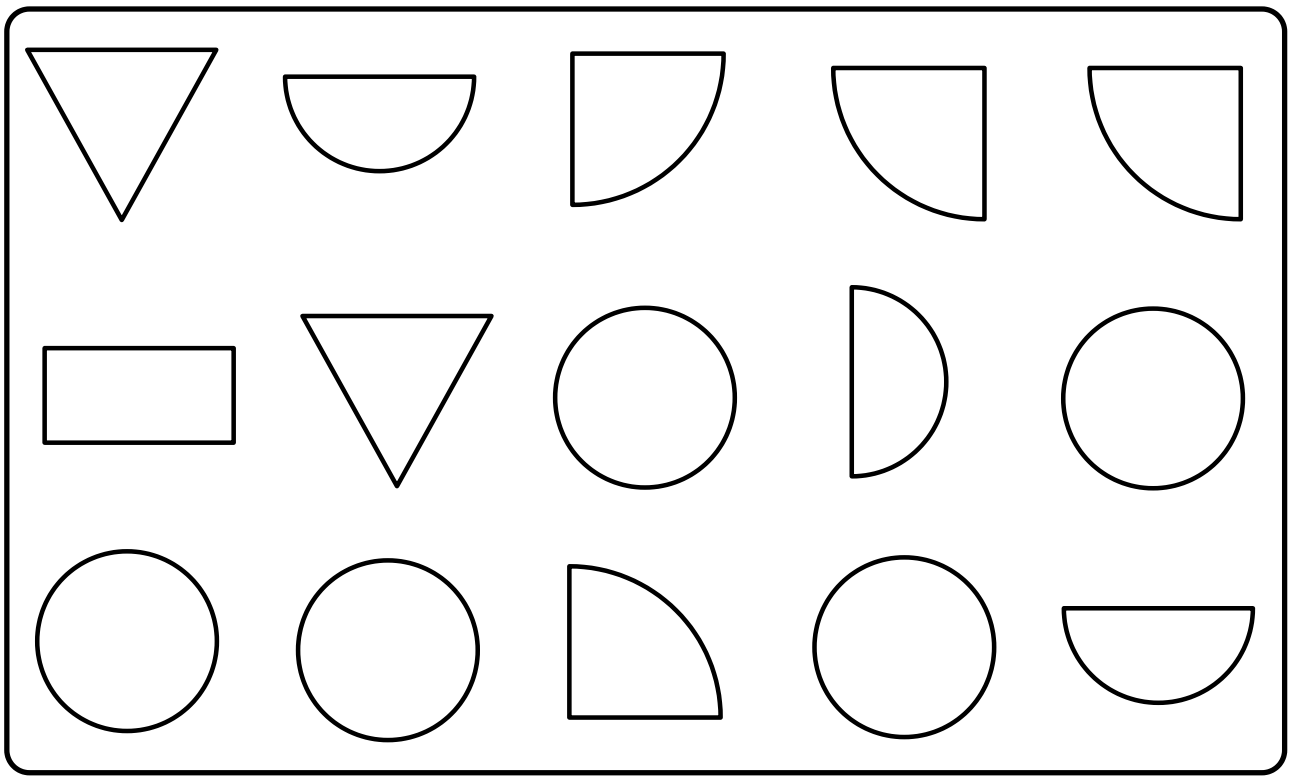
P1-19

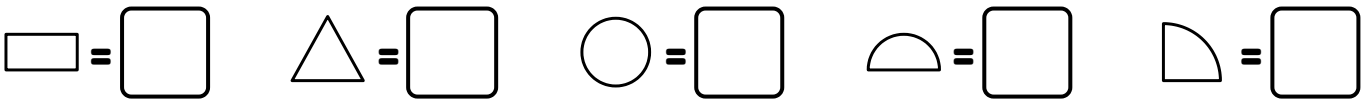
Shape Count

Name _____

Topic: 2D shapes: rectangle, triangle, circle, half circle, quarter circle

Count each kind of shape in the picture.
Write how many in the box.
Use the code table.





Code table

1 = A	2 = D	3 = L	4 = T	5 = U	6 = B
7 = V	8 = X				

Check it. Do your five numbers add to 15? Write the letters. Do they spell a word?

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P1-20

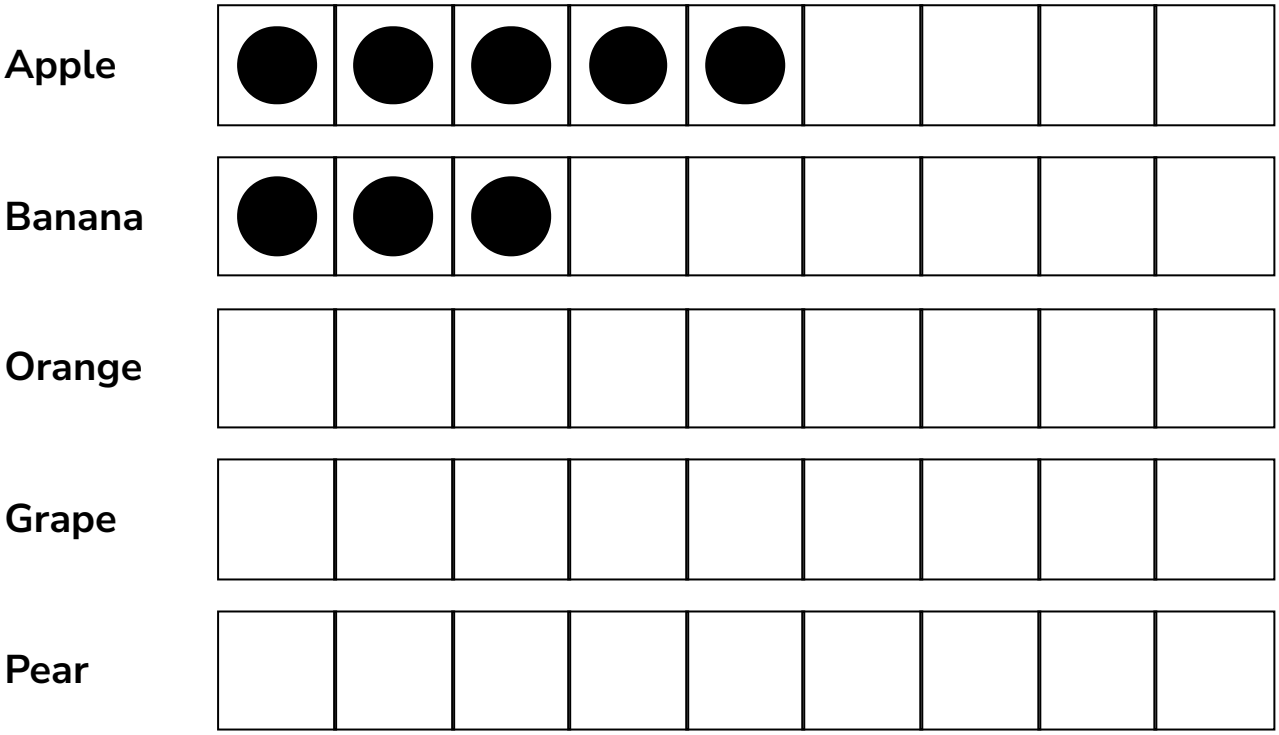
Fruit Graph

★★ Name _____

Topic: Picture graphs: read, complete and answer

Two rows are done.
Use the clues to draw the other rows.
Draw one circle for each child.
Then answer a and b.

Children chose a fruit. ● = 1 child.



- Orange has 2 more than Apple.
- Grape has 2 more than Banana.
- Pear has 1 fewer than Banana.

a) Most children chose ☐.

b) **Apple** has ☐ more than **Pear**.

Check it.
Count all the circles. Is the total 22?
Count the circles in the row you chose in a). Add your answer to b). Is the sum 10?

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